My employment fiasco at the ACS convention two months before was a little eased when an industrial firm finally did ask to interview me through Columbia. I suspect they were not after me specifically, but were going through the list of Columbia soon-to-be graduates.

I spent forty-five minutes with a representative of Carbide and Carbon on November 19, but I wasn't stirred. Their research laboratories were in West Virginia, and I had no intention of going to West Virginia.

12

On November 21, 1947, I finally had a chance to attend a meeting of the Hydra Club.

It was held at the home of Judy Merril down in Greenwich Village and it was there I got to meet her for the first time. Judy was twenty-four at the time, a striking-looking girl, and a quick-witted one who was into women's lib decades ahead of her time. She was the kind of girl who, when her rear end was patted by a man, patted the rear end of the patter.

2 On this day, an abdominal pain of Marcia's was diagnosed as appendicitis, and the appendix was removed before nightfall.

A number of the old Futurians were there, and there was also a young woman who told me she was a Lesbian. She was the first Lesbian I encountered with the knowledge that that was what she was. I was astonished to see that she looked just like an ordinary woman—I don't know what I expected she would look like.

The young woman may, of course, have been pulling my leg, for I suspect she could see from my reactions to what she said that I was not your cool and suave man-about-town. Her tales instantly became lurid as she described her bisexuality and her orgies and I sat there with my eyes like saucers.

*3

On December 16, I got the January 1948 Astounding, which had "Now You See It—" 3 as the cover story. Since the writing of "The Mule," I had been turning out few stories and therefore publishing few. My writing career seemed to be creaking to a halt, and I somehow accepted that as a sign that my chemical career was picking up speed.

Unfortunately, my chemical career was not picking up speed in any visible